BARBARIAN SUBCLASS · D&D 2024

Path of the Hive

A relentless guardian who fights inside a storm of bees, lunges at intruders, and mends on the Hive's royal blood.

V0.1 PLAYTEST BARBARIAN LEVELS 3–14 INSPIRED BY HOLLOW KNIGHT

Deep in the waxen halls of the Hive, warriors are raised for one purpose: to guard their queen. They fight in a living storm of their kin, heal on honey and royal blood, and never retreat from the doorway they've sworn to hold. A Barbarian of the Hive carries that devotion into the world. Their Rage is the swarm's fury, and anyone they choose to protect becomes their queen.

BARBARIAN LEVEL	FEATURES
3rd	Swarm Rage, Hive Lunge
6th	Hiveblood, Hive Honey
10th	Stinger Volley
14th	Queen's Vigil, Living Swarm

LEVEL 3

Swarm Rage

When you enter your Rage, a swarm of bees surrounds you until the Rage ends. Each creature of your choice that starts its turn within 5 feet of you takes Piercing damage equal to your Rage Damage bonus.

LEVEL 3

Hive Lunge

While your Rage is active, once per turn, if you move at least 10 feet in a straight line toward a creature right before hitting it with a melee attack, it takes an extra 1d8 Piercing damage.

LEVEL 6

Hiveblood

The Hive's royal blood mends you. While your Rage is active, at the start of each of your turns, you regain Hit Points equal to your Constitution modifier (minimum of 1). This doesn't work if you have 0 Hit Points.

LEVEL 6

Hive Honey

At the end of a Short Rest, you can share honey with a number of creatures up to your Proficiency Bonus. Each creature that spends Hit Point Dice during that rest regains an extra 1d8 Hit Points.

LEVEL 10

Stinger Volley

While your Rage is active, you can take a Bonus Action to fling a cluster of barbed stingers at a point you can see within 30 feet of you. Each creature in a 10-foot square centered on that point makes a Dexterity saving throw (DC 8 + your Strength modifier + your Proficiency Bonus), taking 3d6 Piercing damage on a failed save or half as much on a success.

The stingers stay embedded in the ground until the start of your next turn. The area is Difficult Terrain, and a creature takes 1d6 Piercing damage for every 5 feet it moves there.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Constitution modifier (minimum of once), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

LEVEL 14

Queen's Vigil

While your Rage is active, when an ally you can see within 30 feet of you takes damage, you can take a Reaction to move up to half your Speed toward them without provoking Opportunity Attacks. If you end this movement within 5 feet of them, you take the damage instead. Your Rage's Resistances apply.

LEVEL 14

Living Swarm

Your Swarm Rage reaches creatures within 10 feet of you, and its damage becomes twice your Rage Damage bonus.

DESIGNER NOTES

- **Lore pulls.** Swarm Rage is the Hive Knight's summoned bees, Hive Lunge is his dashing slash, Stinger Volley is his spiked projectile, Hiveblood is the charm's slow regeneration, and Queen's Vigil is his devotion to Vespa: whoever you protect becomes your queen.
- **Durability.** Hiveblood plus Rage's Resistance makes a very durable Barbarian, closer to the Path of the World Tree than to the Berserker.
- **Automatic damage.** Swarm Rage rewards wading into crowds.
- Is Hiveblood too strong combined with Rage's Resistance?
- Should Swarm Rage's automatic damage need a save at higher levels?
- Got a better name for Stinger Volley?

V0.1 PLAYTEST: FIRST PUBLIC RELEASE

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